There has been a significant increase in the number of anti-Palestinian incidents in the West Bank. Blinken is coming to Israel once again to discuss this worrying development. The responsibility is first and foremost on the settlers, the direct culprits, but also on a government that is unwilling or unable to stop this rabble.

This war against Hamas may be different from those that preceded it in scope and scale, but essentially Israel is waging one and the same war against enemies that want one and the same thing. It is necessary to recall the sequence of conflicts in order to grasp the true depth of the issue and the difficulty one may encounter in finding a permanent solution.

As for the wars' sequence, it is quickly summed up:

The 1948–49 independence war was but the first of the struggles waged against the new State of Israel, but also the last of the repeated assaults against the "Zionist entity," since it was now here to stay. The Balfour Declaration of 1917, which promised the establishment of a Jewish national home in Palestine, was in fact the true founding charter of Zionism, even if the dream of a Jewish state, born of the growth of antisemitism in Eastern and Western Europe, predated it by three decades.

Under the British Mandate beginning in 1920, a spate of Palestinian attacks against Jewish communities, resulting in several hundreds of deaths, did not stop the growth of the Yishuv, which led to the proclamation of the State of Israel on May 15, 1948.

The War of Independence, which Israel won against five Arab states, was followed by a period of constant Palestinian incursions and Israeli reprisals and the short-lived Suez Crisis in 1956, that strange alliance of Israel, France, and Great Britain against Egypt, after Gamal Abdel Nasser's posturing led to his closure of the Suez Canal to Israeli shipping. A few years of relative calm followed until Egypt, this time allied with Syria and Jordan, moved troops into the Sinai Desert and directly challenged Israel, triggering the fateful Six-Day War of June 1967.